throws and breaks the stumps with a direct hit. Faf sprints and dives ... and is short, run out for a heroic 134.

Now what? Has there ever been a more thrilling Test? Sixteen runs are needed from the last three overs, but we are seven wickets down. Do we dash for glory or do we play it safe and make sure we don't lose? Dale walks out to join Vernon, carrying an instruction to be careful and maybe set up a dash in the last over.

Mohammed Shami is bowling. Dale is facing and he leaves anything wide. He then plays the ball into the off side but declines the single. Dale plays out a maiden over. A few spectators boo. It's a two-Test series, and defeat would be a disaster. The downside of losing is greater than our need to win. The Indians feel the same way, and MS puts nine fielders on the boundary as Zaheer bowls the penultimate over. Vernon plays out another maiden.

Shami bowls the last over of the day and, only when it is impossible for us to lose, Dale drives him straight back over his head for six. The Test is drawn, as we finish on 450 for seven, eight runs short ...

We all backed the decision. All three results had been distinctly possible with three overs left, but both teams had peered over the edge and pulled back from the brink. In a two-Test series, there was no margin for error, and a crazy over or two in Johannesburg could have put the series win out of reach.

Jacques Kallis had announced his intention to retire from Test cricket after the second Test, starting at Kingsmead in Durban on Boxing Day 2013, and, thankfully, we played well and were able to give Jacques a proper send-off, winning by 10 wickets and securing a 1–0 series win. At the end, escorted by all his teammates, he walked around the field, carrying the national flag and accepting the applause of the crowd.

It had been another tight match. Replying to India's first-innings total of 334, we had reached 113 for three when I walked out to join Jacques,